Context should survive the chat window.

What repository memory means in practice — for coding agents that must not redo discovery.

10 slides · swipe

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Agents forget. Repositories remember.

If the next session cannot reconstruct why the last one did what it did, the agent redoes hours — or breaks work it didn't understand.

Memory that lives in chat is memory that expires.

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What belongs in repository memory.

01 Tracked vs untracked diagnostic scripts

02 Decisions and the alternatives rejected

03 The verification that failed yesterday, with output

04 State snapshots (DB rows, ports, queue status)

05 What not to touch without reading first

A diary is noise. State is a contract.

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How I wire it into daily work.

01 Agent reads AGENTS.md and recent notes first

02 Decisions get written next to the code they govern

03 The session ends with deltas, not summaries

Design notes and .github are product inputs.

What happens without it.

The agent re-invents a fix that was tried and failed last week. The reviewer sees no reason for the change. The teammate reverts it. The bug returns.

Every lost decision gets re-decided. Usually worse.

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Not this. Not that either.

WRONG

A random notes file

everything dumped
no maintenance
nobody reads it

RIGHT

A living contract

decisions + evidence
always current
linked postmortems

Memory is maintained like code, or it becomes lies.

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The one-line rule.

Files that explain why things are true beat files that describe what they are.

Implementation details rot fastest. Reasons survive.

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Try it this week.

Next session: have your agent open the last design note before touching code. Then ask it what it changed and why. Watch the answers get better.

Context first.
Then, and only then, code.

What it buys you.

Faster onboarding. Reviewers who argue from evidence. Incident reviews with real answers. An agent that stops repeating the same mistake.

**A repository that remembers
is a team that doesn't.**

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REPO MEMORY · KEEP THIS · 10/10

Save this for your next agent handoff.

The best agents aren't the smartest. They're the ones that walk in already knowing yesterday — because the repo told them.

Save for later review

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